



christian brown

Senior Engineering Manager
London, UK

I'm a people leader and solutions architect with a background in online video workflows, content management systems and e-commerce, backed by two decades of experience with well-known, high-traffic, enterprise-level web properties that are created and maintained by globally distributed teams. I empower engineers to create high-quality, reusable, and maintainable solutions using SOLID design principles, automated testing, and continuous integration.

current role

 **Senior Engineering Manager**
eBay in London, UK
Aug 2022 - Now

I lead a team of full-stack engineers in eBay's global shipping division, with team members based in London, Toronto, and Cyprus. Our primary focus is enhancing the revenue-sensitive post-sales shipping experience for sellers on the web in the US, UK, German, Canadian, and Australian markets.

We handle over 30m label purchases per month, supporting a variety of payment methods and complex workflows including: pay now, pay by invoice, pay in store, bulk shipping, returns, tracking, insurance claims, QR codes, customs forms, scan forms, cost adjustments; as well as eBay programmes like: Global Shipping / Exports, Authenticity, and Vault. We build Single Page Applications in React, complemented by back-end microservices in Node.js.

My responsibilities include: fostering good engineering, project prioritisation, capacity planning, stakeholder engagement, career development, performance calibration, and recruitment.

I empower engineers to be customer-focused and consider platform architecture and maintainability over short-term results, resulting in a significant decrease in production outages and customer-reported issues.

previous roles

 **Engineering Manager**
Red Ventures in London, UK
Aug 2021 - Jul 2022 (1yr)

I lead the central Video engineering team of back-end engineers in the US and UK, with additional contractors from South America. We built a new SaaS video ecosystem to support up to two billion unique video-on-demand (VOD) play sessions per year. We also handled live-streaming, captioning, digital asset management, ads integration, analytics, and distribution.

We onboarded CNET, ZDNet, GameSpot, GiantBomb, TV Guide, OnlineMBA, Cord Cutters News, BestColleges, NurseJournal and were in the process of bringing Healthline, Metacritic and LonelyPlanet onto our platform. We worked with vendors such as AWS Elemental, Fastly, Bitmovin, Rev, and Mux.

We built API orchestration and microservices in Node.js (Express) & Go/Golang, CMS integrations in PHP (Symfony, WordPress), and deployed into AWS and GCP with CircleCI on infrastructure managed with Terraform.

 **Lead Software Engineer**
Red Ventures in London, UK
Nov 2020 - Jul 2021 (9mths)

By acquisition from ViacomCBS, reporting to the VP of Engineering, I oversaw the migration of systems and workflows, including setting transition targets, undertaking vendor evaluations, and managing engineering deliverables & stakeholder expectations.

I architected the replacement VOD solution based on GCP, Bitmovin and Fastly, which serves just shy of a billion video play sessions per year. Achievements include saving US\$430,000 first year and US\$275,000pa after that in costs for video content management by removing a vendor from our workflow with minimal impact on users and the business.

specialty verticals

I have subject-matter expertise in:



VOD



e-commerce



CMS

tech

Some of the tech, frameworks and platforms I have recent industry experience with include:



PHP



Symfony



Go/Golang



JavaScript



TypeScript



Node.js



PostgreSQL



MySQL



Redis



Elemental



MPX/CVP



Bitmovin



JW Player



Video.js



Mux



Fastly



GCP



AWS

education



Bachelor of Computer Science, BCompSci (Hons)

University of Western Australia (UWA)
Majored in **Electronic Business and IT Systems**.

Lead Software Engineer

VIACOMCBS ViacomCBS / CBS Interactive in London, UK
Apr 2016 – Oct 2020 (4yrs, 7mths)

I was a team leader with direct reports, reporting to the VP of Engineering, part of a larger central CMS and API team of 13 engineers spread across the US, with support from product, PM, QA and DevOps. We maintained the CMS, REST APIs, and tech stack that powered web properties ViacomCBS operated internationally, including CBS News (inc. 60 Minutes), CBS Sports, 24/7 Sports, MaxPreps, SportsLine, CNET, ZDNet, TechRepublic, Download.com, TV Guide, and many more.

My team and I were subject-matter experts on all video-on-demand (VOD) content - interfacing with internal and third-party vendors for transcoding, storage, metadata management, captioning/transcription, ingestion, publishing, and distribution (e.g., YouTube using Content ID). Achievements include saving US\$500,000pa on video playback costs, bypassing a third-party video platform, and avoiding the pay per play.

Senior Software Engineer



CBS / CBS Interactive in Singapore, then London, UK
Jan 2012 – Mar 2016 (4yrs, 3mths)

Initially based in Singapore as part of a team lead out of Sydney, we maintained a CMS and API stack that powered many of CBS Interactive's international brands. We built a new adaptive and responsive CMS user interface with just a few engineers within a couple of months for ZDNet. Out of that success, our teams merged with the US, building a CMS to power almost all of CBS' web properties, covering broadcast, news, sports, tech, gaming, and food verticals. I led the video workflow integration whilst based in San Francisco for 6wks.

Software Engineer / Web Developer



CNET Networks in London, UK
Sep 2007 – Dec 2011 (4yrs, 4mths)

I was part of an international team supporting localised versions of CNET and ZDNet in the UK, AU, Asia, DE and FR. We developed a Zend-based framework used by engineers in those regions to handle scalability problems such as routing, caching and CDN integration. I also provided support for GameSpot, TV.com and TechRepublic. I delivered training in the Paris office to FR and DE teams; and presented our achievements at our off-site in Singapore.

Associate Programmer



iiNet in Perth, Australia
Jul 2006 – Aug 2007 (1yr, 2mths)

I was part of the Customer Service Tools team within the Applications Dept., responsible for developing and maintaining internal web-based applications to manage customers and staff. We built and supported CRM, billing, HR, and B2B ordering & monitoring systems that integrated third-party telecommunication APIs to process broadband applications with upstream providers (Telstra). I was awarded 'Hardest Worker of the Year' in 2006.

Senior Customer Service Representative



iiNet in Perth, Australia
Jan 2005 – Jun 2006 (1yr, 6mths)

I was a team leader in the contact centre, assisting and coaching customer service representatives, standing in for managers for customers with escalated technical or billing issues, identifying and lodging network-wide faults with operations and liaising with high-value clients. I created a set of web-based customer service tools, including a copper wire attenuation calculator based on raw telecommunications cable data to calculate the theoretical maximum DSL speed and a scheduling/roster user interface. The tools were used by all staff across Australian, NZ and South African offices. I was awarded 'Most Innovative Staff Member' in 2005.

IT Consultant/IT Administrator



Mineral Engineering Technical Services (METS) in Perth, Australia
Jan 2002 – Dec 2004 (3yrs)

Oversaw IT operations, from desktop and server IT support to development, hosting and maintenance of their websites, intranet and other web-based tools. I also provided on-site IT support, consulting and web development for their clientele.

Freelance developer



trading as **Clix Web Development in Perth, Australia**
Main trading period 2001 – 2006 (6yrs)

I provided web development services for small to medium businesses, including hosting and domain name management. Based on my own CMS, I created and supported web properties from simple microsites to intranets and full shopping portals. I worked closely with clients, from concept and design to development, deployment, and support.

side projects



Underpinned

A non-profit micro-business, creating and selling pin badges for charity. See underpinned.org



Smart Home

A dashboard of weather and internal temperature data from the home. See [/smart-home](#)

volunteering



NHS Volunteer Responder

Royal Voluntary Service (RVS)

Science Museum Mass Vaccination Centre, London, UK

Mar 2021 – Sep 2021 (6mths), 420hrs
(70x6hr shifts)

This CV is available online at:

<https://christianbrown.uk>

Get in touch via LinkedIn:

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